



△ Leopard 2A4

Date 1979 **Country** West Germany
Weight 60.8 tons (55.2 tonnes)
Engine MTU MB 873 Ka-501 diesel, 1,500 hp
Main armament 120 mm Rheinmetall 120 L/44 gun

The Leopard 2 introduced the 120 mm smoothbore gun, which soon became the Western standard. Almost 3,000 were produced, with the 2A4 version being the most common. The turret incorporated composite armor made from different materials, which meant it did not have to be sloped to be effective.



◁ M1 Abrams

Date 1980 **Country** USA
Weight 60 tons (54.5 tonnes)
Engine Textron Lycoming AGT1500 gas turbine, 1,500 hp
Main armament 105 mm M68 L/52 rifled gun

The M1 was adopted to replace the aging M60. It featured an advanced Chobham armor, a gas-turbine engine, and a computerized fire-control system. The gas turbine gave it unmatched speed, but at the cost of very high fuel consumption. Later models improved the armor, and the M1A1 replaced its gun with the 120 mm smoothbore.

▽ Challenger 1

Date 1984 **Country** UK
Weight 68.3 tons (62 tonnes)
Engine Perkins CV12 V-12 diesel, 1,200 hp
Main armament 120 mm L11A5 L/55 rifled gun

The Challenger was not intended for the British Army. It was designed for Iran but was cancelled after the revolution in 1979. Internally, it was very similar to a late model of Chieftain, but had a much more reliable engine and hydrogas suspension. It was protected by advanced, top-secret Chobham composite armor. Challenger 1 first saw combat in the Gulf War.

